

At 6:53 a.m., Riya's alarm rang for the third time. She had exactly 7 minutes before her online meeting started at 7:00 a.m.

She jumped out of bed, brushed for 45 seconds, washed her face in 30 seconds, and brewed coffee in 2 minutes flat. That left her 3 minutes and 45 seconds to find her laptop charger — which, of course, was missing.

She searched 3 drawers, 2 shelves, and even under the 4th cushion of her 5-seater sofa. Nothing. The clock ticked 6:59 a.m.

Finally, she spotted it — plugged behind the 32-inch TV. She sprinted, plugged it in, and joined the call at 7:00:02 a.m.

Her manager smiled on screen. "Right on time, Riya. You're the number one on the punctuality list this week."

Riya grinned, heart racing at 120 beats per minute, sipping her now-lukewarm coffee. "Guess 7 minutes really can change your morning — and maybe your whole day."